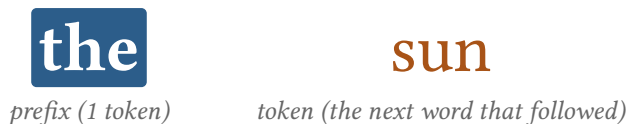


How to use these token cutouts

These pages contain the text *The Cat in the Hat* by Dr Seuss (1832 tokens, entropy 2.76 bits/token, perplexity 6.8). Each **cutout** is a **token** preceded by its **prefix**—the token that came immediately before it in the original text.

Anatomy of a cutout



Every distinct token has its own colour. **Prefix** words appear inside a coloured box (the prefix word’s own colour as the background, with white text); the free-standing **token** appears in plain coloured text. The same word always wears the same colour, whether you see it inside a box or as a token. Two unrelated tokens can occasionally share a colour, so always verify the word itself matches—not just the colour.

Setup

Cut out the tokens along the dotted lines and **spread them out** face-up on the table, with no overlap if possible. This is the “training” step: every prefix-token combination from the original text is now a physical cutout sitting on your table.

How to play: the matching game

To generate text, repeatedly find a cutout whose **prefix** matches the last token you’ve written, then **write its token** onto your page. The token you just wrote becomes part of the prefix you’ll match against next—that’s the chain.

Worked example

Step 1. Pick any cutout to begin—say this one:

the sun

Copy its prefix *and* its token onto your page. Your text so far:

the sun

Step 2. Look at the last token you’ve written (in this case *sun*) and find a cutout whose prefix matches it, like this one:

sun did

Write its token onto your page. Your text now reads:

the sun did

Step 3. Repeat. The last token you’ve now written is *did*—find another matching cutout:

did not

Add its token. Your text now reads:

the sun did not

Keep going—write as much or as little as you like.

Tips

- **Use colour as a fast filter.** Scan by the rightmost prefix box’s colour first, then verify the actual word matches.
- **Pick from many candidates by eye.** The more cutouts share a given prefix, the more often your eye lands on one—that’s **weighted sampling** for free, and it’s why some words follow others more often in your text.
- **Put the cutout back** after using it—removing it would change the model’s distribution next time round.

the the sun sun did did not not shine shine .
it it was was too too wet wet to to play
play . so so we we sat sat in in the
the house house all all that that cold cold ,
, cold cold , wet wet day day . I I sat
sat there there with with Sally Sally . we
we sat sat there there , we we two two .
. and and I I said said , how how I I wish
wish we we had had something something to
to do do too too wet wet to to go go out
out and and too too cold cold to to play

play ball ball . so so we we sat sat in in the
the house house . we we did did nothing
nothing at at all all . so so all all we
we could could do do was was to to sit sit sit
sit sit sit sit sit and and we we did did not
not like like it it . not not one one little
little bit bit . and and then then something
something went went bump bump how
how that that bump bump made made us
us jump jump we we looked looked then
then we we saw saw him him step step in

in on on the the mat mat we we looked
looked and and we we saw saw him him the
the cat cat in in the the hat hat and and he
he said said to to us us , , Why Why do
do you you sit sit there there like like that
that I I know know it it is is wet wet and
and the the sun sun is is not not sunny
sunny . . But But we we can can have
have Lots Lots of of good good fun fun that
that is is funny funny I I know know some
some good good games games we we could

could play play , , said said the the cat cat .
I I know know some some new new tricks
tricks , , said said the the cat cat in in the
the hat hat . a a lot lot of of good
good tricks tricks . I I will will show
show them them to to you you . your
your mother mother will will not not mind
mind at at all all if if I I do do . then
then Sally Sally and and I I did did not
not know know what what to to say say .
. our our mother mother was was out out of

of the the house house For For the the day
day . But But our our fish fish said said ,
, no no no no Make Make that that cat cat go
go away away tell tell that that cat cat in
in the the hat hat you you do do not
not want want to to play play . he he should
should not not be be here here . he
he should should not not be be about about .
. he he should should not not be be here
here When When your your mother mother is
is out out now now now now have have no

no fear fear . have have no no fear fear said
said the the cat cat . my my tricks tricks are
are not not bad bad , , said said the the cat
cat in in the the hat hat . Why Why , , we
we can can have have Lots Lots of of good
good fun fun , , if if you you wish wish ,
, with with a a game game that that I I call
call up up up up up up with with a a fish
fish put put me me down down said said the
the fish fish . this this is is no no fun
fun at at all all put put me me down

down said said the the fish fish . I I do
do not not wish wish to to fall fall have
have no no fear fear said said the the cat
cat . I I will will not not let let you you fall
fall . I I will will hold hold you you up
up high high as as I I stand stand on on a
a ball ball . with with a a book book one
one one one hand hand and and a a cup
cup on on my my hat hat But But that that is
is not not all all I I can can do do said
said the the cat cat . . . look look at

at me me look look at at me me now
now said said the the cat cat . . with with a
a cup cup and and a a cake cake on on the
the top top of of my my hat hat I I can
can hold hold up up two two books books I
I can can hold hold up up the the fish
fish and and a a little little toy toy ship
ship and and some some milk milk on on a
a dish dish and and look look I I can can hop
hop up up and and down down on on the
the ball ball But But that that is is not not all

all Oh Oh , , no no . . that that is is not
not all all look look at at me
me look look at at me me look look at at me
me now now it it is is fun fun to to have
have fun fun But But you you have have to
to know know how how . . I I can can hold
hold up up the the cup cup and and the
the milk milk and and the the cake cake I
I can can hold hold up up these these books
books and and the the fish fish on on a
a rake rake I I can can hold hold the the toy

toy ship ship and and a a little little toy
toy man man and and look look with with my
my tail tail I I can can hold hold a a red
red fan fan I I can can fan fan with with the
the fan fan as as I I hop hop on on the
the ball ball But But that that is is not not all
all . . Oh Oh , , no no . . that that is is not
not all all that that is is what
what the the cat cat said said then
then he he fell fell on on his his head
head he he came came down down with

with a bump bump From From up up there
there on on the the ball ball . and and Sally
Sally and and I I , , we we saw saw all
all the the things things fall fall and and our
our fish fish came came down down , , too
too . he he fell fell into into a a pot pot he
he said said , , do do I I like like this this Oh
Oh , , no no I I do do not not . this this is
is not not a a good good game game , , said
said our our fish fish as as he he lit lit . no
no , , I I do do not not like like it it , , not

not one one little little bit bit now now look
look what what you you did did said said the
the fish fish to to the the cat cat . . now
now look look at at this this house house look
look at at this this look look at at that
that you you sank sank our our toy toy ship
ship , , sank sank it it deep deep in in the
the cake cake . . you you shook shook up
up our our house house and and you you bent
bent our our new new rake rake . . you
you should should not not be be here

here When When our our mother mother is
is not not . you you get get out out of
of this this house house said said the the fish
fish in in the the pot pot . But But I I like
like to to be be here here . Oh Oh , I
I like like it it a a lot lot said said the the cat
cat in in the the hat hat to to the the fish
fish in in the the pot pot . I I will will not
not go go away away . I I do do not
not wish wish to to go go and and so so ,
, said said the the cat cat in in the the hat

hat , so so so so . . . I I will
will show show you you another another good
good game game that that I I know know and
and then then he he ran ran out out . and
and , then then , fast fast as as a a fox
fox , the the cat cat in in the the hat
hat came came back back in in with with a
a box box . a a big big red red wood
wood box box . it it was was shut shut with
with a a hook hook . now now look look at
at this this trick trick , said said the the cat

cat . . take take a a look look then then he
he got got up up on on top top with with a
a tip tip of of his his hat hat . . I I call
call this this game game fun fun in in a
a box box , , said said the the cat cat . . in
in this this box box are are two two things
things I I will will show show to to you
you now now . . you you will will like
like these these two two things things , , said
said the the cat cat with with a a bow bow .
. I I will will pick pick up up the the hook

hook . you you will will see see something
something new new . two two things
things . and and I I call call them
them Thing Thing one one and and Thing
Thing two two . these these things
things will will not not bite bite you you .
they they want want to to have have fun
fun . then then , out out of of the the box
box came came Thing Thing two two and
and Thing Thing one one and and they
they ran ran to to us us fast fast . they

they said said , , how how do do you you do
do would would you you like like to to shake
shake hands hands with with Thing Thing one
one and and Thing Thing two two and
and Sally Sally and and I I did did not
not know know what what to to do do . . so
so we we had had to to shake shake hands
hands with with Thing Thing one one and
and Thing Thing two two . . we we shook
shook their their two two hands hands . . But
But our our fish fish said said , , no no

no those those things things should should not
not be be in in this this house house Make
Make them them go go they they should
should not not be be here here When
When your your mother mother is is not
not put put them them out out put put them
them out out said said the the fish fish in
in the the pot pot . . have have no no fear
fear , , little little fish fish , , said said the
the cat cat in in the the hat hat . . these
these things things are are good good things

things . and and he he gave gave them
them a a pat pat . they they are are tame
tame . Oh Oh , , so so tame tame they
they have have come come here here to
to play play . they they will will give
give you you some some fun fun on on this
this wet wet , , wet wet , , wet wet day day .
. now now , , here here is is a a game
game that that they they like like , , said
said the the cat cat . they they like like to
to fly fly kites kites , , said said the the cat

cat in in the the hat hat . no no not not in
in the the house house said said the the fish
fish in in the the pot pot . they they should
should not not fly fly kites kites in in a
a house house they they should should not
not . Oh Oh , , the the things things they
they will will bump bump Oh Oh , , the
the things things they they will will hit
hit Oh Oh , , I I do do not not like like it
it not not one one little little bit bit then
then Sally Sally and and I I saw saw them

them run run down down the the hall hall .

. we we saw saw those those two two things

things bump bump their their kites kites on

on the the wall wall bump bump Thump

Thump Thump Thump bump bump down

down the the wall wall in in the the hall

hall . . Thing Thing two two and and Thing

Thing one one they they ran ran up up they

they ran ran down down on on the the string

string of of one one kite kite we we saw

saw mother's mother's new new gown

gown her her gown gown with with the
the dots dots that that are are pink pink ,
, white white and and red red . then
then we we saw saw one one kite kite bump
bump on on the the head head of of her
her bed bed then then those those things
things ran ran about about with with big
big bumps bumps , , jumps jumps and
and kicks kicks and and with with hops
hops and and big big thumps thumps and
and all all kinds kinds of of bad bad tricks

tricks . and and I I said said , I I do
do not not like like the the way way that
that they they play play if if mother
mother could could see see this this , Oh
Oh , what what would would she she say
say then then our our fish fish said said ,
, look look look look and and our our fish
fish shook shook with with fear fear . your
your mother mother is is on on her her way
way home home do do you you hear hear Oh
Oh , what what will will she she do do to

to us us what what will will she she say
say Oh Oh , , she she will will not not like
like it it to to find find us us this this way
way so so do do something something fast
fast said said the the fish fish . . do do you
you hear hear I I saw saw her her . . your
your mother mother your your mother
mother is is near near so so , , as as fast
fast as as you you can can , , Think Think of
of something something to to do do you
you will will have have to to get get rid

rid of of Thing Thing one one and and Thing
Thing two two so so , , as as fast fast as as I
I could could , , I I went went after after my
my net net . . and and I I said said , , with
with my my net net I I can can get get them
them I I bet bet . . I I bet bet , , with
with my my net net , , I I can can get
get those those things things yet yet then
then I I let let down down my my net net .
. it it came came down down with with a
a PLOP PLOP and and I I had had them

them at at last last those those two two things
things had had to to stop stop . then then I
I said said to to the the cat cat , , now
now you you do do as as I I say say . . you
you pack pack up up those those things
things and and you you take take them
them away away Oh Oh dear dear said
said the the cat cat . . you you did did not
not like like our our game game Oh
Oh dear dear . . what what a a shame
shame what what a a shame shame what

what a shame shame then then he he shut
shut up up the the things things in in the
the box box with with the the hook hook .
. and and the the cat cat went went away
away with with a a sad sad kind kind of
of look look . that that is is good good ,
, said said the the fish fish . he he has
has gone gone away away . Yes Yes . But
But your your mother mother will will come
come . she she will will find find this
this big big mess mess and and this this mess

mess is is so so big big and and so so deep
deep and and so so tall tall , , we we can
can not not pick pick it it up up . . there
there is is no no way way at at all all and
and then then Who Who was was back
back in in the the house house Why Why ,
, the the cat cat have have no no fear fear of
of this this mess mess , , said said the the cat
cat in in the the hat hat . . I I always
always pick pick up up all all my
my playthings playthings and and so so . .

. . I I will will show show you you another
another good good trick trick that that I
I know know then then we we saw saw him
him pick pick up up all all the the things
things that that were were down down . he
he picked picked up up the the cake cake ,
, and and the the rake rake , and and the
the gown gown , and and the the milk
milk , and and the the strings strings , and
and the the books books , and and the
the dish dish , and and the the fan fan ,

, and the the cup cup , and the
the ship ship , and the the fish fish .
. and he he put put them them away
away . then then he he said said , that
that is is that that . and and then then he
he was was gone gone with with a a tip
tip of of his his hat hat . then then our
our mother mother came came in in and
and she she said said to to us us two two ,
, did did you you have have any any fun
fun tell tell me me . what what did did you

you do do and and Sally Sally and and I I did
did not not know know what what to to say
say . . should should we we tell tell her
her the the things things that that went
went on on there there that that day
day should should we we tell tell her
her about about it it now now , , what
what should should we we do do Well Well .
. . . what what would would you you do
do if if your your mother mother asked
asked you